Eunah Jeong

Motivation Letter

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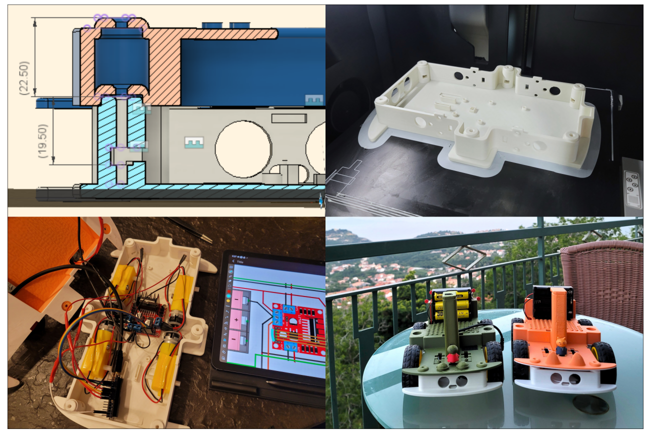
Dear Selection Committee,

I am writing to express my motivation to participate in the summer course *“Designing Social Robots for Human Interaction*". I have previously studied 3D Design and Computer Science, and am currently pursuing Nano Science and Engineering with a growing focus on robotics and artificial intelligence. My current research interests lie in robot learning, particularly in exploring approaches for developing generalist robot policies that enable robots to perform a wide range of physical tasks. I believe that insights from human-robot interaction are becoming increasingly important for this domain, as state-of-the-art generalist policies (e.g. $\pi_{0.5}$, $\pi^*_{0.6}$) are now trained through human interaction, with deployed policies supervised by human corrections or language commands. Further, understanding how humans naturally communicate, collaborate, and respond to robots can provide essential guidance on what capabilities robots should learn in order to interact effectively with people, rather than merely executing predefined behaviors. For this reason, the opportunity to learn about the design and evaluation of social robots strongly motivates me to participate in this program.



OpenBot Assembly. *I have modeled, 3D printed, built, and operated these open-source robots.*

My main expectation for the programme is to gain renewed enthusiasm and inspiration to pursue a research career in robotics. Secondly, I am looking forward to meeting other participants, as I have had limited opportunities so far to connect with peers who are passionate about robotics. I believe that learning together and collaborating on a group project will broaden my perspectives. Thirdly, I am interested in several sessions in the course, in particular on research and design methods in human-robot interaction and social robotics, as well as the discussion of anthropomorphism. I was previously fascinated by a paper describing the design of a lamp-like robot developed using HRI principles (Hu et al., 2025), which made me curious about how such design methodologies are applied in practice. Finally, I am very excited about the prototyping sessions. I enjoy hands-on learning, such as my OpenBot assembly project, and am eager to explore how my background in design can contribute to my journey in robotics.

Through the experience gained from this programme, I hope to incorporate insights from human-robot interaction into my future work. Beyond robot learning, I am interested in how robots can be integrated into our daily lives in ways that enrich human experiences and support human learning. To pursue this direction, I plan to further explore both the literature and practical projects with the foundation that I gained from this programme so that I can contribute to research that benefits both humans and intelligent robotic systems in a meaningful, efficient, and effective way.

Thank you for considering my application.

Eunah Jeong